14 2Ch · 2 Chronicles

1 Now Solomon son of David established himself securely over his kingdom, and
the LORD his God was with him and highly exalted him. [2] Then Solomon spoke to
all Israel, to the commanders of thousands and of hundreds, to the judges, and to
every leader in all Israel—the heads of the families. [3] And Solomon and the whole
assembly went to the high place at Gibeon because it was the location of God's Tent
of Meeting, which Moses the servant of the LORD had made in the wilderness.
[4] Now David had brought the ark of God from Kiriath-jearim to the place he
had prepared for it, because he had pitched a tent for it in Jerusalem. [5] But the
bronze altar made by Bezalel son of Uri, the son of Hur, was in Gibeon before the
tabernacle of the LORD. So Solomon and the assembly inquired of Him there.
[6] Solomon offered sacrifices there before the LORD on the bronze altar in the
Tent of Meeting, where he offered a thousand burnt offerings. [7] That night God
appeared to Solomon and said, "Ask, and I will give it to you!" [8] Solomon replied
to God: "You have shown much loving devotion to my father David, and You have
made me king in his place." [9] Now, O LORD God, let Your promise to my father
David be fulfilled. For You have made me king over a people as numerous as the
dust of the earth. [10] "Now grant me wisdom and knowledge, so that I may lead this
people. For who is able to govern this great people of Yours?"

[11] God said to Solomon, "Since this was in your heart instead of requesting riches
or wealth or glory for yourself or death for your enemies—and since you have not
even requested long life but have asked for wisdom and knowledge to govern My
people over whom I have made you king—" [12] "therefore wisdom and knowledge
have been granted to you. And I will also give you riches and wealth and honor
unlike anything given to the kings before you or after you." [13] So Solomon went to
Jerusalem from the high place in Gibeon before the Tent of Meeting, and he reigned
over Israel. [14] Solomon accumulated 1,400 chariots and 12,000 horses, which he
stationed in the chariot cities and also with him in Jerusalem. [15] The king made silver
and gold as common in Jerusalem as stones, and cedar as abundant as sycamore
in the foothills. [16] Solomon's horses were imported from Egypt and Kue; the royal
merchants purchased them from Kue. [17] A chariot could be imported from Egypt
for six hundred shekels of silver, and a horse for a hundred and fifty. Likewise, they
exported them to all the kings of the Hittites and to the kings of Aram.

2 Now Solomon purposed to build a house for the Name of the LORD and a
royal palace for himself. [2] So he conscripted 70,000 porters, 80,000 stonecutters in
the mountains, and 3,600 supervisors. [3] Then Solomon sent word to Hiram king of
Tyre: "Do for me as you did for my father David when you sent him cedars to build
himself a house to live in." [4] Behold, I am about to build a house for the Name of
the LORD my God to dedicate to Him for burning fragrant incense before Him,
for displaying the showbread continuously, and for making burnt offerings every
morning and evening as well as on the Sabbaths, New Moons, and appointed feasts
of the LORD our God. This is ordained for Israel forever. [5] The house that I am
building will be great, for our God is greater than all gods. [6] But who is able to
build a house for Him, since the heavens, even the highest heavens, cannot contain
Him? Who then am I, that I should build a house for Him, except as a place to
burn sacrifices before Him? [7] Send me, therefore, a craftsman skilled in engraving to
work with gold and silver, with bronze and iron, and with purple, crimson, and blue
yarn. He will work with my craftsmen in Judah and Jerusalem, whom my father
David provided. [8] Send me also cedar, cypress, and algum logs from Lebanon, for I
know that your servants have skill to cut timber there. And indeed, my servants will
work with yours [9] to prepare for me timber in abundance, because the temple I am
building will be great and wonderful. [10] "I will pay your servants, the woodcutters,
20,000 cors of ground wheat, 20,000 cors of barley, 20,000 baths of wine, and
20,000 baths of olive oil."

[11] Then Hiram king of Tyre wrote a letter in reply to Solomon: "Because the
LORD loves His people, He has set you over them as king." [12] And Hiram added:
"Blessed be the LORD, the God of Israel, who made the heavens and the earth! He
has given King David a wise son with insight and understanding, who will build a
temple for the LORD and a royal palace for himself." [13] So now I am sending you
Huram-abi, a skillful man endowed with creativity. [14] He is the son of a woman
from the daughters of Dan, and his father is a man of Tyre. He is skilled in work
with gold and silver, bronze and iron, stone and wood, purple, blue, and crimson
yarn, and fine linen. He is experienced in every kind of engraving and can execute
any design that is given him. He will work with your craftsmen and with those of
my lord, your father David. [15] Now let my lord send to his servants the wheat, barley,
olive oil, and wine he promised. [16] "We will cut logs from Lebanon, as many as you
need, and we will float them to you as rafts by sea down to Joppa. Then you can
take them up to Jerusalem." [17] Solomon numbered all the foreign men in the land
of Israel following the census his father David had conducted, and there were found
to be 153,600 in all. [18] Solomon made 70,000 of them porters, 80,000 stonecutters
in the mountains, and 3,600 supervisors.

3 Then Solomon began to build the house of the LORD in Jerusalem on Mount
Moriah, where the LORD had appeared to his father David. This was the place
that David had prepared on the threshing floor of Ornan the Jebusite. [2] Solomon
began construction on the second day of the second month in the fourth year
of his reign. [3] The foundation that Solomon laid for the house of God was sixty
cubits long and twenty cubits wide, according to the old standard. [4] The portico
at the front, extending across the width of the temple, was twenty cubits long and
twenty cubits high. He overlaid the inside with pure gold. [5] He paneled the main
room with cypress, which he overlaid with fine gold and decorated with palm trees
and chains. [6] He adorned the temple with precious stones for beauty, and its gold
was from Parvaim.

[7] He overlaid its beams, thresholds, walls, and doors with gold, and he
carved cherubim on the walls. [8] Then he made the Most Holy Place; its length
corresponded to the width of the temple—twenty cubits long and twenty cubits
wide. And he overlaid the inside with six hundred talents of fine gold. [9] The weight
of the nails was fifty shekels of gold. He also overlaid the upper area with gold. [10] In
the Most Holy Place he made two cherubim of sculptured work, and he overlaid
them with gold. [11] The total wingspan of the cherubim was twenty cubits. One
wing of the first cherub was five cubits long and touched the wall of the temple,
and its other wing was five cubits long and touched the wing of the other cherub.
[12] The wing of the second cherub also measured five cubits and touched the wall
of the temple, while its other wing measured five cubits and touched the wing of
the first cherub. [13] So the total wingspan of these cherubim was twenty cubits.
They stood on their feet, facing the main room. [14] He made the veil of blue, purple,
and crimson yarn and fine linen, with cherubim woven into it. [15] In front of the
temple he made two pillars, which together were thirty-five cubits high, each with
a capital on top measuring five cubits. [16] He made interwoven chains and put them
on top of the pillars. He made a hundred pomegranates and fastened them into
the chainwork. [17] Then he set up the pillars in front of the temple, one on the south
and one on the north. The pillar on the south he named Jachin, and the pillar on
the north he named Boaz.

4 He made a bronze altar twenty cubits long, twenty cubits wide, and ten
cubits high. [2] He also made the Sea of cast metal. It was circular in shape, measuring
ten cubits from rim to rim, five cubits in height, and thirty cubits in circumference.
[3] Below the rim, figures of oxen encircled it, ten per cubit all the way around the Sea,
cast in two rows as a part of the Sea. [4] The Sea stood on twelve oxen, three facing
north, three facing west, three facing south, and three facing east. The Sea rested on
them, with all their hindquarters toward the center. [5] It was a handbreadth thick,
and its rim was fashioned like the brim of a cup, like a lily blossom. It could hold
three thousand baths. [6] He also made ten basins for washing and placed five on the
south side and five on the north. The parts of the burnt offering were rinsed in
them, but the priests used the Sea for washing.

[7] He made ten gold lampstands according to their specifications and placed them
in the temple, five on the south side and five on the north. [8] Additionally, he made
ten tables and placed them in the temple, five on the south side and five on the
north. He also made a hundred gold bowls. [9] He made the courtyard of the priests
and the large court with its doors, and he overlaid the doors with bronze.

[10] He put the Sea on the south side, at the southeast corner. [11] Additionally, Huram
made the pots, shovels, and sprinkling bowls. So Huram finished the work that he
had undertaken for King Solomon in the house of God: [12] the two pillars; the two
bowl-shaped capitals atop the pillars; the two sets of network covering both bowls
of the capitals atop the pillars; [13] the four hundred pomegranates for the two sets
of network (two rows of pomegranates for each network covering both the bowl-
shaped capitals atop the pillars); [14] the stands; the basins on the stands; [15] the Sea; the
twelve oxen underneath the Sea; [16] and the pots, shovels, meat forks, and all the other
articles. All these objects that Huram-abi made for King Solomon for the house of
the LORD were of polished bronze. [17] The king had them cast in clay molds in the
plain of the Jordan between Succoth and Zeredah. [18] Solomon made all these articles
in such great abundance that the weight of the bronze could not be determined.
[19] Solomon also made all the furnishings for the house of God: the golden altar; the
tables on which was placed the Bread of the Presence; [20] the lampstands of pure gold
and their lamps, to burn in front of the inner sanctuary as prescribed; [21] the flowers,
lamps, and tongs of gold—of purest gold; [22] the wick trimmers, sprinkling bowls,
ladles, and censers of purest gold; and the gold doors of the temple: the inner doors
to the Most Holy Place as well as the doors of the main hall.

5 So all the work that Solomon had performed for the house of the LORD was
completed. Then Solomon brought in the items his father David had dedicated—
the silver, the gold, and all the furnishings—and he placed them in the treasuries
of the house of God. [2] At that time Solomon assembled in Jerusalem the elders of
Israel—all the tribal heads and family leaders of the Israelites—to bring up the ark
of the covenant of the LORD from Zion, the City of David. [3] So all the men of

Israel came together to the king at the feast in the seventh month. [4] When all the elders of Israel had arrived, the Levites took up the ark, [5] and they brought up the ark and the Tent of Meeting with all its sacred furnishings. The Levitical priests carried them up. [6] There, before the ark, King Solomon and the whole congregation of Israel who had assembled with him sacrificed so many sheep and oxen that they could not be counted or numbered. [7] Then the priests brought the ark of the covenant of the LORD to its place in the inner sanctuary of the temple, the Most Holy Place, beneath the wings of the cherubim. [8] For the cherubim spread their wings over the place of the ark and overshadowed the ark and its poles. [9] The poles of the ark extended far enough that their ends were visible from in front of the inner sanctuary, but not from outside the Holy Place; and they are there to this day. [10] There was nothing in the ark except the two tablets that Moses had placed in it at Horeb, where the LORD had made a covenant with the Israelites after they had come out of Egypt. [11] Now all the priests who were present had consecrated themselves regardless of their divisions. And when the priests came out of the Holy Place, [12] all the Levitical singers—Asaph, Heman, Jeduthun, and their sons and relatives—stood on the east side of the altar, dressed in fine linen and playing cymbals, harps, and lyres, accompanied by 120 priests sounding trumpets. [13] The trumpeters and singers joined together to praise and thank the LORD with one voice. They lifted up their voices, accompanied by trumpets, cymbals, and musical instruments, in praise to the LORD: "For He is good; His loving devotion endures forever." And the temple, the house of the LORD, was filled with a cloud [14] so that the priests could not stand there to minister because of the cloud; for the glory of the LORD filled the house of God.

6 Then Solomon declared: "The LORD has said that He would dwell in the thick cloud;" [2] "and I have built You an exalted house, a place for You to dwell forever." [3] And as the whole assembly of Israel stood there, the king turned around and blessed them all [4] and said: "Blessed be the LORD, the God of Israel, who has fulfilled with His own hand what He spoke with His mouth to my father David, saying," [5] 'Since the day I brought My people out of the land of Egypt, I have not chosen a city from any tribe of Israel in which to build a house so that My Name would be there, nor have I chosen anyone to be ruler over My people Israel.' [6] But now I have chosen Jerusalem for My Name to be there, and I have chosen David to be over My people Israel.' [7] Now it was in the heart of my father David to build a house for the Name of the LORD, the God of Israel. [8] But the LORD said to my father David, 'Since it was in your heart to build a house for My Name, you have done well to have this in your heart.' [9] Nevertheless, you are not the one to build it; but your son, your own offspring, will build the house for My Name.' [10] Now the LORD has fulfilled the word that He spoke. I have succeeded my father David, and I sit on the throne of Israel, as the LORD promised. I have built the house for the Name of the LORD, the God of Israel. [11] "And there I have provided a place for the ark, which contains the covenant of the LORD that He made with the children of Israel." [12] Then Solomon stood before the altar of the LORD in front of the whole assembly of Israel and spread out his hands. [13] Now Solomon had made a bronze platform five cubits long, five cubits wide, and three cubits high, and had placed it in the middle of the courtyard. He stood on it, knelt down before the whole assembly of Israel, spread out his hands toward heaven, [14] and said: "O LORD, God of Israel, there is no God like You in heaven or on earth, keeping Your covenant of loving devotion with Your servants who walk before You with all their hearts." [15] You have kept Your promise to Your servant, my father David. What You spoke with Your mouth You have fulfilled with Your hand this day. [16] Therefore now, O LORD, God of Israel, keep for Your servant, my father David, what You promised when You said: 'You will never fail to have a man to sit before Me on the throne of Israel, if only your descendants guard their way to walk in My law as you have walked before Me.' [17] And now, O LORD, God of Israel, please confirm what You promised to Your servant David.

[18] But will God indeed dwell with man upon the earth? Even heaven, the highest heaven, cannot contain You, much less this temple I have built. [19] Yet regard the prayer and plea of Your servant, O LORD my God, so that You may hear the cry and the prayer that Your servant is praying before You. [20] May Your eyes be open toward this temple day and night, toward the place where You said You would put Your Name, so that You may hear the prayer that Your servant prays toward this place. [21] Hear the plea of Your servant and of Your people Israel when they pray toward this place. May You hear from heaven, Your dwelling place. May You hear and forgive. [22] When a man sins against his neighbor and is required to take an oath, and he comes to take an oath before Your altar in this temple, [23] then may You hear from heaven and act. May You judge Your servants, condemning the wicked man by bringing down on his own head what he has done, and justifying the righteous man by rewarding him according to his righteousness. [24] When Your people Israel are defeated before an enemy because they have sinned against You, and they return to You and confess Your name, praying and pleading before You in this temple, [25] then may You hear from heaven and forgive the sin of Your people Israel. May You restore them to the land You gave to them and their fathers. [26] When the skies are shut and there is no rain because Your people have sinned against You, and they pray toward this place and confess Your name, and they turn from their sins because You have afflicted them, [27] then may You hear from heaven and forgive the sin of Your servants, Your people Israel, so that You may teach them the good way in which they should walk. May You send rain on the land that You gave Your people as an inheritance.

[28] When famine or plague comes upon the land, or blight or mildew or locusts or grasshoppers, or when their enemies besiege them in their cities, whatever plague or sickness may come, [29] then may whatever prayer or petition Your people Israel make —each knowing his own afflictions and spreading out his hands toward this temple — [30] be heard by You from heaven, Your dwelling place. And may You forgive and repay each man according to all his ways, since You know his heart—for You alone know the hearts of men— [31] so that they may fear You and walk in Your ways all the days they live in the land that You gave to our fathers. [32] And as for the foreigner who is not of Your people Israel but has come from a distant land because of Your great name and Your mighty hand and outstretched arm—when he comes and prays toward this temple, [33] then may You hear from heaven, Your dwelling place, and do according to all for which the foreigner calls to You. Then all the peoples of the earth will know Your name and fear You, as do Your people Israel, and they will know that this house I have built is called by Your Name. [34] When Your people go to war against their enemies, wherever You send them, and when they pray to You in the direction of the city You have chosen and the house I have built for Your Name, [35] then may You hear from heaven their prayer and their plea, and may You uphold their cause. [36] When they sin against You—for there is no one who does not sin— and You become angry with them and deliver them to an enemy who takes them as captives to a land far or near, [37] and when they come to their senses in the land to which they were taken, and they repent and plead with You in the land of their captors, saying, 'We have sinned and done wrong; we have acted wickedly,' [38] and when they return to You with all their heart and soul in the land of the enemies who took them captive, and when they pray in the direction of the land that You gave to their fathers, the city You have chosen, and the house I have built for Your Name, [39] then may You hear from heaven, Your dwelling place, their prayer and petition, and may You uphold their cause. May You forgive Your people who sinned against You. [40] Now, my God, may Your eyes be open and Your ears attentive to the prayer offered in this place. [41] Now therefore, arise, O LORD God, and enter Your resting place, You and the ark of Your might. May Your priests, O LORD God, be clothed with salvation, and may Your godly ones rejoice in goodness. [42] "O LORD God, do not reject Your anointed one. Remember Your loving devotion to Your servant David."

7 When Solomon had finished praying, fire came down from heaven and consumed the burnt offering and the sacrifices, and the glory of the LORD filled the temple. [2] The priests were unable to enter the house of the LORD, because the glory of the LORD had filled it. [3] When all the Israelites saw the fire coming down and the glory of the LORD above the temple, they bowed down on the pavement with their faces to the ground, and they worshiped and gave thanks to the LORD: "For He is good; His loving devotion endures forever." [4] Then the king and all the people offered sacrifices before the LORD. [5] And King Solomon offered a sacrifice of 22,000 oxen and 120,000 sheep. So the king and all the people dedicated the house of God. [6] The priests stood at their posts, as did the Levites with the musical instruments of the LORD, which King David had made for giving thanks to the LORD and with which David had offered praise, saying, "For His loving devotion endures forever." Across from the Levites, the priests sounded trumpets, and all the Israelites were standing.

[7] Then Solomon consecrated the middle of the courtyard in front of the house of the LORD, and there he offered the burnt offerings and the fat of the peace offerings, since the bronze altar he had made could not contain all these offerings. [8] So at that time Solomon and all Israel with him—a very great assembly of people from Lebo-hamath to the Brook of Egypt—kept the feast for seven days. [9] On the eighth day they held a solemn assembly, for the dedication of the altar had lasted seven days, and the feast seven days more. [10] On the twenty-third day of the seventh month, Solomon sent the people away to their homes, joyful and glad of heart for the good things that the LORD had done for David, for Solomon, and for His people Israel. [11] When Solomon had finished the house of the LORD and the royal palace, successfully carrying out all that was in his heart to do for the house of the LORD and for his own palace, [12] the LORD appeared to him at night and said to him: "I have heard your prayer and have chosen this place for Myself as a house of sacrifice." [13] If I close the sky so there is no rain, or if I command the locust to devour the land, or if I send a plague among My people, [14] and if My people who are called by My name humble themselves and pray and seek My face and turn from their wicked ways, then I will hear from heaven, forgive their sin, and heal their land. [15] Now My eyes will be open and My ears attentive to the prayers offered in this place. [16] For I have now chosen and consecrated this temple so that My Name may be there forever. My eyes and My heart will be there for all time.

[17] And as for you, if you walk before Me as your father David walked, doing all I have commanded you, and if you keep My statutes and ordinances, [18] then I will establish your royal throne, as I covenanted with your father David when I said, 'You will never fail to have a man to rule over Israel.' [19] But if you turn away and forsake

the statutes and commandments I have set before you, and if you go off to serve and worship other gods, [20] then I will uproot Israel from the soil I have given them, and I will banish from My presence this temple I have sanctified for My Name. I will make it an object of scorn and ridicule among all the peoples. [21] And when this temple has become a heap of rubble, all who pass by it will be appalled and say, 'Why has the LORD done such a thing to this land and to this temple?' [22] "And others will answer, 'Because they have forsaken the LORD, the God of their fathers, who brought them out of the land of Egypt, and have embraced other gods, worshiping and serving them—because of this, He has brought all this disaster upon them.'"

8 Now at the end of the twenty years during which Solomon had built the house of the LORD and his own palace, [2] Solomon rebuilt the cities Hiram had given him and settled Israelites there. [3] Then Solomon went to Hamath-zobah and captured it. [4] He built Tadmor in the wilderness, in addition to all the store cities that he had built in Hamath. [5] He rebuilt Upper and Lower Beth-horon as fortified cities with walls, gates, and bars, [6] as well as Baalath, all the store cities that belonged to Solomon, and all the cities for his chariots and horses—whatever he desired to build in Jerusalem, Lebanon, and throughout the land of his dominion. [7] As for all the people who remained of the Hittites, Amorites, Perizzites, Hivites, and Jebusites (the people who were not Israelites)— [8] their descendants who remained in the land, those whom the Israelites were unable to destroy—Solomon conscripted these people to be forced laborers, as they are to this day. [9] But Solomon did not consign any of the Israelites to slave labor, because they were his men of war, his officers and captains, and the commanders of his chariots and cavalry. [10] They were also the chief officers for King Solomon: 250 supervisors. [11] Solomon brought the daughter of Pharaoh up from the City of David to the palace he had built for her. For he said, "My wife must not live in the house of David king of Israel, because the places the ark of the LORD has entered are holy."

[12] At that time Solomon offered burnt offerings to the LORD on the altar of the LORD he had built in front of the portico. [13] He observed the daily requirement for offerings according to the commandment of Moses for Sabbaths, New Moons, and the three annual appointed feasts—the Feast of Unleavened Bread, the Feast of Weeks, and the Feast of Tabernacles. [14] In keeping with the ordinances of his father David, Solomon appointed the divisions of the priests over their service, and the Levites for their duties to offer praise and to minister before the priests according to the daily requirement. He also appointed gatekeepers by their divisions at each gate, for this had been the command of David, the man of God. [15] They did not turn aside from the king's command regarding the priests or the Levites or any matter concerning the treasuries. [16] Thus all the work of Solomon was carried out, from the day the foundation was laid for the house of the LORD until it was finished. So the house of the LORD was completed. [17] Then Solomon went to Ezion-geber and to Eloth on the coast of Edom. [18] So Hiram sent him ships captained by his servants, along with crews of experienced sailors. They went with Solomon's servants to Ophir and acquired from there 450 talents of gold, which they delivered to King Solomon.

9 Now when the queen of Sheba heard about the fame of Solomon, she came to test him with difficult questions. She arrived in Jerusalem with a very large caravan —with camels bearing spices, gold in abundance, and precious stones. So she came to Solomon and spoke with him about all that was on her mind. [2] And Solomon answered all her questions; nothing was too difficult for him to explain. [3] When the queen of Sheba saw the wisdom of Solomon, the palace he had built, [4] the food at his table, the seating of his servants, the service and attire of his attendants and cupbearers, and the burnt offerings he presented at the house of the LORD, it took her breath away. [5] She said to the king, "The report I heard in my own country about your words and wisdom is true." [6] But I did not believe the reports until I came and saw with my own eyes. Indeed, not half of the greatness of your wisdom was told to me. You have far exceeded the report I heard. [7] How blessed are your men! How blessed are these servants of yours who stand continually before you and hear your wisdom! [8] "Blessed be the LORD your God, who has delighted in you to set you on His throne to be king for the LORD your God. Because your God loved Israel enough to establish them forever, He has made you king over them to carry out justice and righteousness." [9] Then she gave the king 120 talents of gold, a great quantity of spices, and precious stones. There had never been such spices as those the queen of Sheba gave to King Solomon.

[10] (The servants of Hiram and of Solomon who brought gold from Ophir also brought algum wood and precious stones. [11] The king made the algum wood into steps for the house of the LORD and for the king's palace, and into lyres and harps for the singers. Never before had anything like them been seen in the land of Judah.) [12] King Solomon gave the queen of Sheba all she desired—whatever she asked—far more than she had brought the king. Then she left and returned to her own country, along with her servants. [13] The weight of gold that came to Solomon each year was 666 talents, [14] not including the revenue from the merchants and traders. And all the Arabian kings and governors of the land also brought gold and silver to Solomon.

[15] King Solomon made two hundred large shields of hammered gold; six hundred shekels of hammered gold went into each shield. [16] He also made three hundred small shields of hammered gold; three hundred shekels of gold went into each shield. And the king put them in the House of the Forest of Lebanon. [17] Additionally, the king made a great throne of ivory and overlaid it with pure gold. [18] The throne had six steps, and a footstool of gold was attached to it. There were armrests on both sides of the seat, with a lion standing beside each armrest. [19] Twelve lions stood on the six steps, one at either end of each step. Nothing like this had ever been made for any kingdom.

[20] All King Solomon's drinking cups were gold, and all the utensils of the House of the Forest of Lebanon were pure gold. There was no silver, because it was accounted as nothing in the days of Solomon. [21] For the king had the ships of Tarshish that went with Hiram's servants, and once every three years the ships of Tarshish would arrive bearing gold, silver, ivory, apes, and peacocks. [22] So King Solomon surpassed all the kings of the earth in riches and wisdom. [23] All the kings of the earth sought an audience with Solomon to hear the wisdom that God had put in his heart. [24] Year after year, each visitor would bring his tribute: articles of silver and gold, clothing, weapons, spices, horses, and mules. [25] Solomon had 4,000 stalls for horses and chariots, and 12,000 horses, which he stationed in the chariot cities and also with him in Jerusalem. [26] He reigned over all the kings from the Euphrates to the land of the Philistines, as far as the border of Egypt. [27] The king made silver as common in Jerusalem as stones, and cedar as abundant as sycamore in the foothills. [28] Solomon's horses were imported from Egypt and from all the lands. [29] As for the rest of the acts of Solomon, from beginning to end, are they not written in the Records of Nathan the Prophet, in the Prophecy of Ahijah the Shilonite, and in the Visions of Iddo the Seer concerning Jeroboam son of Nebat? [30] Solomon reigned in Jerusalem over all Israel forty years. [31] And Solomon rested with his fathers and was buried in the city of his father David. And his son Rehoboam reigned in his place.

10 Then Rehoboam went to Shechem, for all Israel had gone there to make him king. [2] When Jeroboam son of Nebat heard about this, he returned from Egypt, where he had fled from King Solomon. [3] So they sent for Jeroboam, and he and all Israel came to Rehoboam and said, [4] "Your father put a heavy yoke on us. But now you should lighten the burden of your father's service and the heavy yoke he put on us, and we will serve you." [5] Rehoboam answered, "Come back to me in three days." So the people departed. [6] Then King Rehoboam consulted with the elders who had served his father Solomon during his lifetime. "How do you advise me to respond to these people?" he asked. [7] They replied, "If you will be kind to these people and please them by speaking kind words to them, they will be your servants forever." [8] But Rehoboam rejected the advice of the elders; instead, he consulted the young men who had grown up with him and served him. [9] He asked them, "What message do you advise that we send back to these people who have spoken to me, saying, 'Lighten the yoke your father put on us'?"

[10] The young men who had grown up with him replied, "This is how you should answer these people who said to you, 'Your father made our yoke heavy, but you should make it lighter.' This is what you should tell them: 'My little finger is thicker than my father's waist!'" [11] "Whereas my father burdened you with a heavy yoke, I will add to your yoke. Whereas my father scourged you with whips, I will scourge you with scorpions.'" [12] After three days, Jeroboam and all the people returned to Rehoboam, since the king had said, "Come back to me on the third day." [13] And the king answered them harshly. King Rehoboam rejected the advice of the elders [14] and spoke to them as the young men had advised, saying, "Whereas my father made your yoke heavy, I will add to your yoke. Whereas my father scourged you with whips, I will scourge you with scorpions." [15] So the king did not listen to the people, and indeed this turn of events was from God, in order that the LORD might fulfill the word that He had spoken through Ahijah the Shilonite to Jeroboam son of Nebat. [16] When all Israel saw that the king had refused to listen to them, they answered the king: "What portion do we have in David, and what inheritance in the son of Jesse? To your tents, O Israel! Look now to your own house, O David!" So all the Israelites went home, [17] but Rehoboam still reigned over the Israelites living in the cities of Judah. [18] Then King Rehoboam sent out Hadoram, who was in charge of the forced labor, but the Israelites stoned him to death. And King Rehoboam mounted his chariot in haste and escaped to Jerusalem. [19] So to this day Israel has been in rebellion against the house of David.

11 When Rehoboam arrived in Jerusalem, he mobilized the house of Judah and Benjamin—180,000 chosen warriors—to fight against Israel and restore the kingdom to Rehoboam. [2] But the word of the LORD came to Shemaiah the man of God: [3] "Tell Rehoboam son of Solomon king of Judah and all the Israelites in Judah and Benjamin" [4] "that this is what the LORD says: 'You are not to go up and fight against your brothers. Each of you must return home, for this word is from Me.'" So they listened to the words of the LORD and turned back from going against Jeroboam. [5] Rehoboam continued to live in Jerusalem, and he built up cities for defense in Judah. [6] He built up Bethlehem, Etam, Tekoa, [7] Beth-zur, Soco, Adullam, [8] Gath, Mareshah, Ziph, [9] Adoraim, Lachish, Azekah, [10] Zorah, Aijalon, and Hebron, the fortified cities in Judah and Benjamin. [11] He strengthened their fortresses and put officers in them, with supplies of food, oil, and wine. [12] He also put shields and spears in all the cities and strengthened them greatly. So

Judah and Benjamin belonged to him. [13] Moreover, the priests and Levites from all their districts throughout Israel stood with Rehoboam. [14] For the Levites left their pasturelands and their possessions and went to Judah and Jerusalem, because Jeroboam and his sons had rejected them as priests of the LORD.

[15] And Jeroboam appointed his own priests for the high places and for the goat demons and calf idols he had made. [16] Those from every tribe of Israel who had set their hearts to seek the LORD their God followed the Levites to Jerusalem to sacrifice to the LORD, the God of their fathers.

[17] So they strengthened the kingdom of Judah and supported Rehoboam son of Solomon for three years, because they walked for three years in the way of David and Solomon. [18] And Rehoboam married Mahalath, who was the daughter of David's son Jerimoth and of Abihail, the daughter of Jesse's son Eliab. [19] She bore sons to him: Jeush, Shemariah, and Zaham. [20] After her, he married Maacah daughter of Absalom, and she bore to him Abijah, Attai, Ziza, and Shelomith. [21] Rehoboam loved Maacah daughter of Absalom more than all his wives and concubines. In all, he had eighteen wives and sixty concubines, and he was the father of twenty-eight sons and sixty daughters. [22] Rehoboam appointed Abijah son of Maacah as chief prince among his brothers, intending to make him king. [23] Rehoboam also acted wisely by dispersing some of his sons throughout the districts of Judah and Benjamin, and to all the fortified cities. He gave them abundant provisions and sought many wives for them.

12 After Rehoboam had established his sovereignty and royal power, he and all Israel with him forsook the Law of the LORD. [2] In the fifth year of Rehoboam's reign, because they had been unfaithful to the LORD, Shishak king of Egypt came up and attacked Jerusalem [3] with 1,200 chariots, 60,000 horsemen, and countless troops who came with him out of Egypt—Libyans, Sukkites, and Cushites. [4] He captured the fortified cities of Judah and came as far as Jerusalem. [5] Then Shemaiah the prophet came to Rehoboam and the leaders of Judah who had gathered at Jerusalem because of Shishak, and he said to them, "This is what the LORD says: 'You have forsaken Me; therefore, I have forsaken you into the hand of Shishak.'" [6] So the leaders of Israel and the king humbled themselves and said, "The LORD is righteous." [7] When the LORD saw that they had humbled themselves, the word of the LORD came to Shemaiah, saying, "They have humbled themselves; I will not destroy them, but will soon grant them deliverance. My wrath will not be poured out on Jerusalem through Shishak."

[8] "Nevertheless, they will become his servants, so that they may learn the difference between serving Me and serving the kings of other lands." [9] So King Shishak of Egypt attacked Jerusalem and seized the treasures of the house of the LORD and of the royal palace. He took everything, including the gold shields that Solomon had made. [10] Then King Rehoboam made bronze shields in their place and committed them to the care of the captains of the guard on duty at the entrance to the royal palace. [11] And whenever the king entered the house of the LORD, the guards would go with him, bearing the shields, and later they would return them to the guardroom. [12] Because Rehoboam humbled himself, the anger of the LORD turned away from him, and He did not destroy him completely. Indeed, conditions were good in Judah. [13] Thus King Rehoboam established himself in Jerusalem. He was forty-one years old when he became king, and he reigned seventeen years in Jerusalem, the city the LORD had chosen from all the tribes of Israel in which to put His Name. His mother's name was Naamah the Ammonite. [14] And Rehoboam did evil because he did not set his heart to seek the LORD. [15] Now the acts of Rehoboam, from first to last, are they not written in the records of Shemaiah the Prophet and of Iddo the Seer concerning the genealogies? There was war between Rehoboam and Jeroboam throughout their days. [16] And Rehoboam rested with his fathers and was buried in the City of David. And his son Abijah reigned in his place.

13 In the eighteenth year of Jeroboam's reign, Abijah became king of Judah, [2] and he reigned in Jerusalem three years. His mother's name was Micaiah daughter of Uriel; she was from Gibeah. And there was war between Abijah and Jeroboam. [3] Abijah went into battle with an army of 400,000 chosen men, while Jeroboam drew up in formation against him with 800,000 chosen and mighty men of valor. [4] Then Abijah stood on Mount Zemaraim in the hill country of Ephraim and said, "Hear me, O Jeroboam and all Israel!" [5] Do you not know that the LORD, the God of Israel, has given the kingship of Israel to David and his descendants forever by a covenant of salt? [6] Yet Jeroboam son of Nebat, a servant of Solomon son of David, rose up and rebelled against his master.

[7] Then worthless and wicked men gathered around him to resist Rehoboam son of Solomon when he was young, inexperienced, and unable to resist them. [8] And now you think you can resist the kingdom of the LORD, which is in the hands of David's descendants. You are indeed a vast army, and you have with you the golden calves that Jeroboam made for you as gods. [9] But did you not drive out the priests of the LORD, the sons of Aaron, and the Levites? And did you not make priests for yourselves as do the peoples of other lands? Now whoever comes to consecrate himself with a young bull and seven rams can become a priest of things that are not gods. [10] But as for us, the LORD is our God. We have not forsaken Him; the priests who minister to the LORD are sons of Aaron, and the Levites attend to their duties. [11] Every morning and every evening they present burnt offerings and fragrant incense to the LORD. They set out the rows of showbread on the ceremonially clean table, and every evening they light the lamps of the gold lampstand. We are carrying out the requirements of the LORD our God, while you have forsaken Him. [12] "Now behold, God Himself is with us as our head, and His priests with their trumpets sound the battle call against you. O children of Israel, do not fight against the LORD, the God of your fathers, for you will not succeed."

[13] Now Jeroboam had sent troops around to ambush from the rear, so that while he was in front of Judah, the ambush was behind them.

[14] When Judah turned and discovered that the battle was both before and behind them, they cried out to the LORD. Then the priests blew the trumpets, [15] and the men of Judah raised the battle cry. And when they raised the cry, God routed Jeroboam and all Israel before Abijah and Judah. [16] So the Israelites fled before Judah, and God delivered them into their hands. [17] Then Abijah and his people struck them with a mighty blow, and 500,000 chosen men of Israel fell slain. [18] Thus the Israelites were subdued at that time, and the men of Judah prevailed because they relied on the LORD, the God of their fathers. [19] Abijah pursued Jeroboam and captured some cities from him: Bethel, Jeshanah, and Ephron, along with their villages. [20] Jeroboam did not again recover his power during the days of Abijah, and the LORD struck him down and he died. [21] But Abijah grew strong, married fourteen wives, and became the father of twenty-two sons and sixteen daughters. [22] Now the rest of the acts of Abijah, along with his ways and his words, are written in the Treatise of the Prophet Iddo.

14 Then Abijah rested with his fathers and was buried in the City of David. And his son Asa reigned in his place, and in his days the land was at peace for ten years. [2] And Asa did what was good and right in the eyes of the LORD his God. [3] He removed the foreign altars and high places, shattered the sacred pillars, and chopped down the Asherah poles. [4] He commanded the people of Judah to seek the LORD, the God of their fathers, and to observe the law and the commandments. [5] He also removed the high places and incense altars from all the cities of Judah, and under him the kingdom was at peace. [6] Because the land was at peace, Asa built fortified cities in Judah. In those days no one made war with him, because the LORD had given him rest. [7] So he said to the people of Judah, "Let us build these cities and surround them with walls and towers, with doors and bars. The land is still ours because we have sought the LORD our God. We have sought Him and He has given us rest on every side." So they built and prospered. [8] Asa had an army of 300,000 men from Judah bearing large shields and spears, and 280,000 men from Benjamin bearing small shields and drawing the bow. All these were mighty men of valor. [9] Then Zerah the Cushite came against them with an army of 1,000,000 men and 300 chariots, and they advanced as far as Mareshah.

[10] So Asa marched out against him and lined up in battle formation in the Valley of Zephathah near Mareshah. [11] Then Asa cried out to the LORD his God: "O LORD, there is no one besides You to help the powerless against the mighty. Help us, O LORD our God, for we rely on You, and in Your name we have come against this multitude. O LORD, You are our God. Do not let a mere mortal prevail against You." [12] So the LORD struck down the Cushites before Asa and Judah, and the Cushites fled. [13] Then Asa and his army pursued them as far as Gerar. The Cushites fell and could not recover, for they were crushed before the LORD and His army. So the people of Judah carried off a great amount of plunder [14] and attacked all the cities around Gerar, because the terror of the LORD had fallen upon them. They plundered all the cities, since there was much plunder there. [15] They also attacked the tents of the herdsmen and carried off many sheep and camels. Then they returned to Jerusalem.

15 Now the Spirit of God came upon Azariah son of Oded. [2] So he went out to meet Asa and said to him, "Listen to me, Asa and all Judah and Benjamin. The LORD is with you when you are with Him. If you seek Him, He will be found by you, but if you forsake Him, He will forsake you." [3] For many years Israel has been without the true God, without a priest to instruct them, and without the law. [4] But in their distress they turned to the LORD, the God of Israel, and sought Him, and He was found by them. [5] In those days there was no safety for travelers, because the residents of the lands had many conflicts. [6] Nation was crushed by nation, and city by city, for God afflicted them with all kinds of adversity. [7] "But as for you, be strong; do not be discouraged, for your work will be rewarded." [8] When Asa heard these words and the prophecy of Azariah son of Oded the prophet, he took courage and removed the detestable idols from the whole land of Judah and Benjamin and from the cities he had captured in the hill country of Ephraim. He then restored the altar of the LORD that was in front of the portico of the LORD's temple.

[9] And he assembled all Judah and Benjamin, along with those from the tribes of Ephraim, Manasseh, and Simeon who had settled among them, for great numbers had come over to him from Israel when they saw that the LORD his God was with him. [10] So they gathered together in Jerusalem in the third month of the fifteenth year of Asa's reign. [11] At that time they sacrificed to the LORD seven hundred oxen and seven thousand sheep from all the plunder they had brought back. [12] Then they entered into a covenant to seek the LORD, the God

of their fathers, with all their heart and soul. [13] And whoever would not seek the LORD, the God of Israel, would be put to death, whether young or old, man or woman. [14] They took an oath to the LORD with a loud voice, with shouting, trumpets, and rams' horns. [15] And all Judah rejoiced over the oath, for they had sworn it with all their heart. They had sought Him earnestly, and He was found by them. So the LORD gave them rest on every side. [16] King Asa also removed his grandmother Maacah from her position as queen mother because she had made a detestable Asherah pole. Asa chopped down the pole, crushed it, and burned it in the Kidron Valley. [17] The high places were not removed from Israel, but Asa's heart was fully devoted all his days. [18] And he brought into the house of God the silver and gold articles that he and his father had dedicated. [19] And there was no war until the thirty-fifth year of Asa's reign.

16 In the thirty-sixth year of Asa's reign, Baasha king of Israel went up against Judah and fortified Ramah to prevent anyone from leaving or entering the territory of Asa king of Judah. [2] So Asa withdrew the silver and gold from the treasuries of the house of the LORD and the royal palace, and he sent it with this message to Ben-hadad king of Aram, who was ruling in Damascus: [3] "Let there be a treaty between me and you, between my father and your father. See, I have sent you silver and gold. Now go and break your treaty with Baasha king of Israel, so that he will withdraw from me." [4] And Ben-hadad listened to King Asa and sent the commanders of his armies against the cities of Israel, conquering Ijon, Dan, Abel-maim, and all the store cities of Naphtali. [5] When Baasha learned of this, he stopped fortifying Ramah and abandoned his work. [6] Then King Asa brought all the men of Judah, and they carried away the stones of Ramah and the timbers Baasha had used for building. And with these materials he built up Geba and Mizpah. [7] At that time Hanani the seer came to King Asa of Judah and told him, "Because you have relied on the king of Aram and not on the LORD your God, the army of the king of Aram has escaped from your hand." [8] Were not the Cushites and Libyans a vast army with many chariots and horsemen? Yet because you relied on the LORD, He delivered them into your hand. [9] "For the eyes of the LORD roam to and fro over all the earth, to show Himself strong on behalf of those whose hearts are fully devoted to Him. You have acted foolishly in this matter. From now on, therefore, you will be at war." [10] Asa was angry with the seer and became so enraged over this matter that he put the man in prison. And at the same time Asa oppressed some of the people. [11] Now the rest of the acts of Asa, from beginning to end, are indeed written in the Book of the Kings of Judah and Israel. [12] In the thirty-ninth year of his reign, Asa became diseased in his feet, and his malady became increasingly severe. Yet even in his illness he did not seek the LORD, but only the physicians. [13] So in the forty-first year of his reign, Asa died and rested with his fathers. [14] And he was buried in the tomb that he had cut out for himself in the City of David. They laid him on a bier that was full of spices and various blended perfumes; then they made a great fire in his honor.

17 Asa's son Jehoshaphat reigned in his place, and he strengthened himself against Israel. [2] He stationed troops in every fortified city of Judah and put garrisons in the land of Judah and in the cities of Ephraim that his father Asa had captured. [3] Now the LORD was with Jehoshaphat because he walked in the earlier ways of his father David. He did not seek out the Baals, [4] but he sought the God of his father and walked by His commandments rather than the practices of Israel. [5] So the LORD established the kingdom in his hand, and all Judah brought him tribute, so that he had an abundance of riches and honor. [6] And his heart took delight in the ways of the LORD; furthermore, he removed the high places and Asherah poles from Judah. [7] In the third year of his reign, Jehoshaphat sent his officials Ben-hail, Obadiah, Zechariah, Nethanel, and Micaiah to teach in the cities of Judah, [8] accompanied by certain Levites—Shemaiah, Nethaniah, Zebadiah, Asahel, Shemiramoth, Jehonathan, Adonijah, Tobijah, and Tob-adonijah—along with the priests Elishama and Jehoram.

[9] They taught throughout Judah, taking with them the Book of the Law of the LORD. They went throughout the towns of Judah and taught the people. [10] And the dread of the LORD fell upon all the kingdoms of the lands that surrounded Judah, so that they did not make war against Jehoshaphat. [11] Some Philistines also brought gifts and silver as tribute to Jehoshaphat, and the Arabs brought him 7,700 rams and 7,700 goats from their flocks. [12] Jehoshaphat grew stronger and stronger, and he built fortresses and store cities in Judah [13] and kept vast supplies in the cities of Judah. He also had warriors in Jerusalem who were mighty men of valor. [14] These are their numbers according to the houses of their fathers: From Judah, the commanders of thousands: Adnah the commander, and with him 300,000 mighty men of valor; [15] next to him, Jehohanan the commander, and with him 280,000; [16] and next to him, Amasiah son of Zichri, the volunteer for the LORD, and with him 200,000 mighty men of valor. [17] From Benjamin: Eliada, a mighty man of valor, and with him 200,000 armed with bows and shields; [18] and next to him, Jehozabad, and with him 180,000 armed for battle. [19] These were the men who served the king, besides those he stationed in the fortified cities throughout Judah.

18 Now Jehoshaphat had riches and honor in abundance, and he allied himself with Ahab by marriage. [2] And some years later he went down to visit Ahab in Samaria, where Ahab sacrificed many sheep and cattle for him and the people with him, and urged him to march up to Ramoth-gilead. [3] Ahab king of Israel asked Jehoshaphat king of Judah, "Will you go with me against Ramoth-gilead?" And Jehoshaphat replied, "I am like you, and my people are your people; we will join you in the war." [4] But Jehoshaphat also said to the king of Israel, "Please inquire first for the word of the LORD." [5] So the king of Israel assembled the prophets, four hundred men, and asked them, "Should we go to war against Ramoth-gilead, or should we refrain?" "Go up," they replied, "and God will deliver it into the hand of the king." [6] But Jehoshaphat asked, "Is there not still a prophet of the LORD here of whom we can inquire?" [7] The king of Israel answered, "There is still one man who can ask the LORD, but I hate him because he never prophesies anything good for me, but only bad. He is Micaiah son of Imlah." "The king should not say that!" Jehoshaphat replied. [8] So the king of Israel called one of his officials and said, "Bring Micaiah son of Imlah at once." [9] Dressed in royal attire, the king of Israel and Jehoshaphat king of Judah were sitting on their thrones at the threshing floor by the entrance of the gate of Samaria, with all the prophets prophesying before them. [10] Now Zedekiah son of Chenaanah had made for himself iron horns and declared, "This is what the LORD says: 'With these you shall gore the Arameans until they are finished off.'"

[11] And all the prophets were prophesying the same, saying, "Go up to Ramoth-gilead and prosper, for the LORD will deliver it into the hand of the king." [12] Then the messenger who had gone to call Micaiah instructed him, "Behold, with one accord the words of the prophets are favorable to the king. So please let your words be like theirs, and speak favorably." [13] But Micaiah said, "As surely as the LORD lives, I will speak whatever my God tells me." [14] When Micaiah arrived, the king asked him, "Micaiah, should we go to war against Ramoth-gilead, or should we refrain?" "Go up and triumph," Micaiah replied, "for they will be given into your hand." [15] But the king said to him, "How many times must I make you swear not to tell me anything but the truth in the name of the LORD?"

[16] So Micaiah declared: "I saw all Israel scattered on the hills like sheep without a shepherd. And the LORD said, 'These people have no master; let each one return home in peace.'" [17] Then the king of Israel said to Jehoshaphat, "Did I not tell you that he never prophesies good for me, but only bad?" [18] Micaiah continued, "Therefore hear the word of the LORD: I saw the LORD sitting on His throne, and all the host of heaven standing on His right and on His left." [19] And the LORD said, 'Who will entice Ahab king of Israel to march up and fall at Ramoth-gilead?' And one suggested this, and another that. [20] Then a spirit came forward, stood before the LORD, and said, 'I will entice him.' 'By what means?' asked the LORD. [21] And he replied, 'I will go out and be a lying spirit in the mouths of all his prophets.' 'You will surely entice him and prevail,' said the LORD. 'Go and do it.'

[22] "So you see, the LORD has put a lying spirit in the mouths of these prophets of yours, and the LORD has pronounced disaster against you." [23] Then Zedekiah son of Chenaanah went up, struck Micaiah in the face, and demanded, "Which way did the Spirit of the LORD go when He departed from me to speak with you?" [24] Micaiah replied, "You will soon see, on that day when you go and hide in an inner room." [25] And the king of Israel declared, "Take Micaiah and return him to Amon the governor of the city and to Joash the king's son," [26] "and tell them that this is what the king says: 'Put this man in prison and feed him only bread and water until I return safely.'" [27] But Micaiah replied, "If you ever return safely, the LORD has not spoken through me." Then he added, "Take heed, all you people!" [28] So the king of Israel and Jehoshaphat king of Judah went up to Ramoth-gilead. [29] And the king of Israel said to Jehoshaphat, "I will disguise myself and go into battle, but you wear your royal robes." So the king of Israel disguised himself and went into battle. [30] Now the king of Aram had ordered his chariot commanders, "Do not fight with anyone, small or great, except the king of Israel." [31] When the chariot commanders saw Jehoshaphat, they said, "This is the king of Israel!" So they turned to fight against him, but Jehoshaphat cried out, and the LORD helped him. God drew them away from him. [32] And when the chariot commanders saw that he was not the king of Israel, they turned back from pursuing him. [33] However, a certain man drew his bow without taking special aim, and he struck the king of Israel between the joints of his armor. So the king said to his charioteer, "Turn around and take me out of the battle, for I am badly wounded!" [34] The battle raged throughout that day, and the king of Israel propped himself up in his chariot facing the Arameans until evening. And at sunset he died.

19 When Jehoshaphat king of Judah had returned safely to his home in Jerusalem, [2] Jehu son of Hanani the seer went out to confront him and said to King Jehoshaphat, "Should you help the wicked and love those who hate the LORD? Because of this, the wrath of the LORD is upon you." [3] "However, some good is found in you, for you have removed the Asherah poles from the land and have set your heart on seeking God." [4] Jehoshaphat lived in Jerusalem, and once again he went out among the people from Beersheba to the hill country of Ephraim and turned them back to the LORD, the God of their fathers. [5] He appointed judges in the land, in each of the fortified cities of Judah. [6] Then he said to the judges, "Consider carefully what you do, for you are not judging for man, but for the LORD, who is with you when you render judgment." [7] "And now, may the fear

of the LORD be upon you. Be careful what you do, for with the LORD our God there is no injustice or partiality or bribery." [8] Moreover, Jehoshaphat appointed in Jerusalem some of the Levites, priests, and heads of the Israelite families to judge on behalf of the LORD and to settle disputes. And they lived in Jerusalem. [9] He commanded them, saying, "You must serve faithfully and wholeheartedly in the fear of the LORD." [10] For every dispute that comes before you from your brothers who dwell in their cities—whether it regards bloodshed or some other violation of law, commandments, statutes, or ordinances—you are to warn them, so that they will not incur guilt before the LORD and wrath will not come upon you and your brothers. Do this, and you will not incur guilt. [11] "Note that Amariah, the chief priest, will be over you in all that pertains to the LORD, and Zebadiah son of Ishmael, the ruler of the house of Judah, in all that pertains to the king. And the Levites will serve as officers before you. Act resolutely; may the LORD be with the upright!"

20 After this, the Moabites and Ammonites, together with some of the Meunites, came to make war against Jehoshaphat. [2] Then some men came and told Jehoshaphat, "A vast army is coming against you from Edom, from beyond the Sea; they are already in Hazazon-tamar" (that is, En-gedi). [3] Jehoshaphat was alarmed and set his face to seek the LORD. And he proclaimed a fast throughout Judah. [4] So the people of Judah gathered to seek the LORD, and indeed, they came from all the cities of Judah to seek Him. [5] Then Jehoshaphat stood in the assembly of Judah and Jerusalem in the house of the LORD in front of the new courtyard [6] and said, "O LORD, God of our fathers, are You not the God who is in heaven, and do You not rule over all the kingdoms of the nations? Power and might are in Your hand, and no one can stand against You." [7] Our God, did You not drive out the inhabitants of this land before Your people Israel and give it forever to the descendants of Abraham Your friend? [8] They have lived in the land and have built in it a sanctuary for Your Name, saying, [9] 'If disaster comes upon us—whether sword or judgment, plague or famine—we will stand before this temple and before You, for Your Name is in this temple. We will cry out to You in our distress, and You will hear us and save us.' [10] And now, here are the men of Ammon, Moab, and Mount Seir, whom You did not let Israel invade when they came out of the land of Egypt; but Israel turned away from them and did not destroy them. [11] See how they are repaying us by coming to drive us out of the possession that You gave us as an inheritance.

[12] "Our God, will You not judge them? For we are powerless before this vast army that comes against us. We do not know what to do, but our eyes are upon You." [13] Meanwhile all the men of Judah, with their wives and children and little ones, were standing before the LORD. [14] Then the Spirit of the LORD came upon Jahaziel son of Zechariah, the son of Benaiah, the son of Jeiel, the son of Mattaniah, a Levite from Asaph's descendants, as he stood in the midst of the assembly. [15] And he said, "Listen, all you people of Judah and Jerusalem! Listen, King Jehoshaphat! This is what the LORD says: 'Do not be afraid or discouraged because of this vast army, for the battle does not belong to you, but to God.'" [16] Tomorrow you are to march down against them. You will see them coming up the Ascent of Ziz, and you will find them at the end of the valley facing the Wilderness of Jeruel. [17] "You need not fight this battle. Take up your positions, stand firm, and see the salvation of the LORD on your behalf, O Judah and Jerusalem. Do not be afraid or discouraged. Go out and face them tomorrow, for the LORD is with you.'"

[18] Then Jehoshaphat bowed facedown, and all the people of Judah and Jerusalem fell down before the LORD to worship Him.